

Implementing Project Based Learning Over one unit

- Rhea Mendiratta

Group size: 10

Participants: Teachers

Duration: 30 min

- Objectives:
- A. understanding the benefits of PBL
 - B. investment in conducting a PBL unit
 - C. familiarity with progression
 - D. clarity in next steps and actionables

1. WHY?

Think of yourself as a professional who is facing a challenge

Setting: You work at SuperSuds, a company that makes soap.

Challenge: Find an earth-friendly way to produce soap in the future Criteria: budget + few requirements

What will you do? [take responses; make them visible; connect them to my responses]

- organized and managed a team who researched options
- team created material summarizing the issue and their findings
- asked for feedback → presented findings to boss

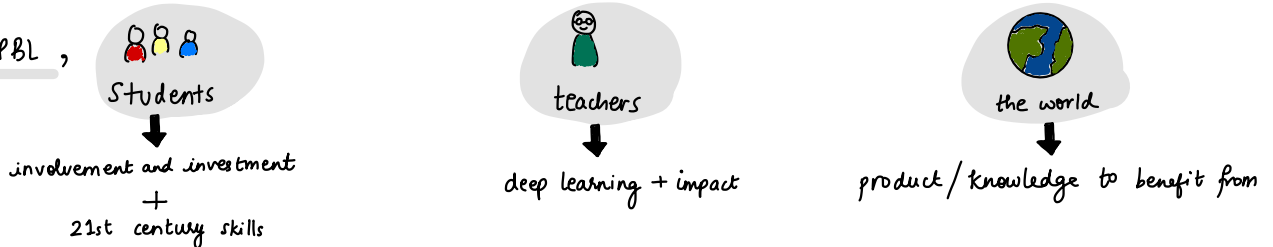
What will you get out of this project? [take responses; make them visible; connect them to my responses]

- you will look like a rockstar! → you will learn a lot about green products
- you will practice 21st century skills like critical thinking, collaboration, and communication

All things we would LOVE for our children to practice

In the real world, we keep coming up with projects to solve problems—why not in school?!

With PBL,



2. WHAT?

PBL is a main-course project; unlike a dessert project

Progression

Driving Q + criteria



Inquiry process



Finding solutions



Present student findings

“ PBL is a teaching method in which students gain knowledge and skills by working for an extended period of time to investigate and respond to an authentic, engaging, and complex question, problem, or challenge. ”

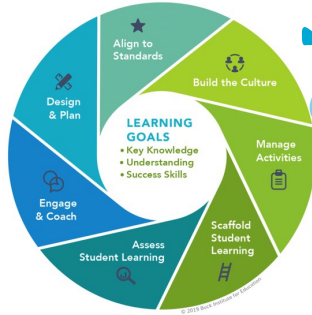
3. WHY ARE WE HERE?

How? (what can it look like in a classroom?) → Next steps?

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4. HOW?



PROJECT BASED TEACHING PRACTICES

ESSENTIAL PROJECT DESIGN ELEMENTS



① Subject? (1 or more)

↳ ② Which chapters do you want to combine to make this unit?

↳ ③ What are the:

- Key points
- Skills
- Concepts

Imagine an ideal graduate of this project!
↓
Rigorous content

DESIGN AND PLAN
ALIGN TO STANDARDS

CHALLENGING PROBLEM/QUESTION

④ Driving question + criteria

⑤ "Need to knows"

→ let the students come up with a list of things they will need to know how to do (skills/concepts/knowledge)

BUILD THE CULTURE

⑥ Divide students into groups

SUSTAINED INQUIRY

⑦ Inquiry process

- ↳ students ask relevant questions
- ↳ students perform primary and secondary research
- * class time can be utilised to impart knowledge and skills using different pedagogical approaches depending on the subject and differentiation needs

⑧ Students:

- collaborate
- give each other feedback
- figure out the best way to solve the problem

⑨ Finding solution

⑩ Bring in field-experts to interact with students

↳ students course-correct and make changes, as needed

⑪ Present student findings

↳ communicate about the project to a real audience or a client

AUTHENTICITY

STUDENT VOICE AND CHOICE

REFLECTION

ENGAGE AND COACH

CRITIQUE AND REVISION

PUBLIC PRODUCT

EXAMPLE FROM MY CLASSROOM

English Writing Unit

- Op-eds → Creative Writing
- Reporting → Grammar and Editing
- Publishing

- How can we address a lack of general awareness and sense of belonging in our community using a newsletter?

- 'Balaknama': newspaper run by children

Groups

- News → Opinion
- Features → Photography + Journalism
- ↳ sub-committees
- Writing → Editing
- Typesetting → Marketing and Distribution

Classroom Activities

- Secondary research
- writing workshops
- reading well-written artefacts and breaking them down

- Calling in a journalist to give her point of view [Pratiksha Mishra]

- Published online and in print!
→ distributed in the community.

"tell me and I forget ; teach me and I remember ; involve me and I learn."

5. NEXT STEPS

- Go through steps 1-4 to arrive at a Driving Question for your PBL unit.
- Connect this driving question to a criteria that will help guide students through solving the problem and maintain reasonable rigour.

6. EXIT SLIP → Google form → Connect, extend, challenge + feedback + link to PBL GDrive folder

DOABLE

RELATABLE

Most of the resources shared in this plan have been taken from pblworks.org